

Michael Sacks

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Employment

Clarkson University

Assistant Professor of Economics and Financial Studies 2020-present
Affiliated Faculty, Institute for a Sustainable Environment

University of Louisville

Visiting Assistant Professor 2018-2020

West Virginia University

Visiting Assistant Professor 2016-2018

Education

University of California, Irvine

Ph.D. Economics Irvine, CA 2011 – 2016

University of California, Irvine

M.A. Social Sciences: Mathematical Behavioral Sciences Irvine, CA 2011 – 2014

Towson University

B.S. Economics, summa cum laude & departmental honors Towson, MD 2006 – 2010

Fields of Expertise

- Industrial Organization; Game Theory; Public Economics; Political Economy.

Publications

1. (Forthcoming) Reimbursing Consumers' Switching Costs in Network Industries (with Jiawei Chen). *Journal of Economics & Management Strategy*.
2. (2024) Radicalization (with Jean-Paul Carvalho). *The Economic Journal*, 134, pp. 1019-1068.
3. (2024) Failed Secular Revolutions: Religious Belief, Competition, and Extremism (with Jean-Paul Carvalho and Jared Rubin). *Public Choice*, 200, pp. 561-586.
4. (2021) Incentives for the Over-Provision of Public Goods. *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, 191, pp. 197-213.
5. (2021) The Economics of Religious Communities (with Jean-Paul Carvalho). *Journal of Public Economics*, 201, Article No. 104481.
6. (2018) Going Along or Going Independent? A Dynamic Analysis of Nonprofit Franchising (with Jiawei Chen). *B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis and Policy*, 18(2).
7. (2017) Education, Identity, and Community: Lessons from Jewish Emancipation (with Jean-Paul Carvalho and Mark Koyama). *Public Choice*, 171(1), pp. 119-143.

8. (2015) Competition between open source and proprietary software: strategies for survival. *Journal of Management Information Systems*, 32(3), pp. 268-295.

Ongoing Research

1. Dynamic Price Competition and Evolutionary Behavior with Search (with Blake Allison, *Revise and Resubmit*, *International Journal of Industrial Organization*)
2. Incubation and the Emergence of Identity-Based Organizations.
3. Advertising, Political Preferences, and Partial Foreclosure in Multisided Platforms.
4. Antidiscrimination and Collective Action: An Evolutionary Approach.
5. Searching for Extremists (with Jean-Paul Carvalho).

Teaching

- Clarkson University: Principles of Macroeconomics, Intermediate Microeconomics*, Economics of Innovation*, Industrial and Supply Chain Economics*, Independent Study in Microeconomics*, Industrial Organization and the Supply Chain (graduate MBA), Applied Economics (graduate MBA).
- University of Louisville: Principles of Macroeconomics, Honors Seminar: Global Economic Issues, Economics of Entrepreneurship, Economics of Antitrust, Game Theory*.
- West Virginia University: Principles of Microeconomics, Principles of Macroeconomics, Intermediate Microeconomics*, Mathematical Economics*.
- UC Irvine: Intermediate Economics II*, Probability and Statistics for Economics II, Game Theory I*.

* Denotes calculus-based courses.

Professional Service

- Referee - *B.E. Journal of Economic Analysis and Policy*, *Canadian Journal of Economics*, *Contemporary Economic Policy*, *Eastern Economic Journal*, *Economics of Governance*, *Industry and Innovation*, *Journal of Comparative Economics*, *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, *Journal of Institutional Economics*, *Journal of Management Information Systems*, *Journal of Public Economic Theory*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *Journal for the Scientific Study of Religion*, *Public Choice*, *Scandinavian Journal of Economics*, *Scientific Reports*, *Social Choice and Welfare*, *Social Science Journal*,
- Reh Center Advisory Council, Clarkson University (2025-present),
- Recruiting and Marketing Committee, Clarkson University (2024-present),
- Undergraduate Recruiting Committee, Clarkson University (2022-present, Chair 2024-present),
- Undergraduate Policy Committee, Clarkson University (2022-present, Chair 2024-present),
- Learning Resources Committee, Clarkson University (2024-present),

- Operations Manual Revisions Committee, Clarkson University (2024),
- School of Business Reimagining Clarkson Taskforce (2023),
- Economics Coordinator, Mathematical Economics Major, Clarkson University (2021-present),
- Faculty Advisor, Omicron Delta Epsilon International Economics Honors Society (2021-present),
- Graduate Studies Committee - West Virginia University Economics Department (2017-2018),
- Graduate student liaison - UC Irvine Economics Department,
- Mentor for incoming graduate students - UC Irvine Economics Department,
- Coordinator - Institute for Mathematical Behavioral Sciences (IMBS) Friday Seminar Series (2014-2016); Twelfth, Thirteenth, and Fourteenth Annual IMBS Graduate Student Conference (2014-2016).

Presentations

- **2025** ASREC Conference (upcoming).
- **2024** Reh School Seminar Series.
- **2024** Oklahoma State University.
- **2023** ASREC Conference, Society for the Advancement of Economic Theory Annual Conference.
- **2022** 2022 ASREC Europe Conference.
- **2020** Louisiana State University, Clarkson University.
- **2019** U.S. Federal Trade Commission, U.S. Department of Justice.
- **2018** University of Central Arkansas, 16th Annual International Industrial Organization Conference, Christopher Newport University.
- **2017** 2017 North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society, 15th Annual International Industrial Organization Conference.
- **2016** European Association for Research in Industrial Economics 43rd Annual Conference, Western Economic Association 91st Annual Conference, IMBS Seminar, UC Irvine.
- **2015** UC Irvine: Theory, History, and Development, IMBS and Institute for the Study of Religion, Economics, and Society (Chapman University) Workshop on the Economics of Religion and Culture, Towson University.
- **2014** UC Irvine: Theory, History, and Development, Twelfth Annual IMBS Graduate Student Conference, Tenth Annual California Graduate Student Conference: Center for the Study of Democracy, IMBS Seminar, UC Irvine (2x).
- **2013** IMBS Seminar, UC Irvine.

Awards

- MBA Professor of the Year, Clarkson University (2025),
- Outstanding New Teacher Award, Clarkson University (2023),
- Summer Grant, NET Institute (2016),
- Jean-Claude Falmagne Dissertation Award, UC Irvine (2016),
- A. Kimball Romney Award for outstanding graduate paper: “Public and Club Goods When Private Costs Have Negative Externalities,” UC Irvine (2016),
- Sheen T. Kassouf Fellowship for best graduate student, UC Irvine (2015-2016),
- Dissertation Completion Fellowship, UC Irvine (2016),
- Outstanding TA Award, UC Irvine (2014),
- IMBS Service Award (2014, 2015, 2016),
- Merit Fellowship in Economics, UC Irvine (Spring, 2015),
- UC Irvine Summer Research Fellowship (2014, 2015),
- Merit Fellowship in Economics, UC Irvine: (2011-2016),
- Social Science Tuition Fellowship, UC Irvine (2011),
- Provost’s Scholarship Towson University (2006-2010),
- Departmental Honors, Economics, Towson University (2010).